



Course Title: Islamic Studies/Ethics

Course Code: SS007

Course Coordinator: Qurat ul Ain Fatima

Email: quratulain.fatima@lhr.nu.edu.pk

Week-03

Chapter# 03

The Belief System of Islam

The Belief System of Islam

Definition of Belief (Imān) in Islam

Linguistic Definition:

The Arabic word for belief is "Imān", derived from the root 'a-m-n (أ-م-ن), which conveys the sense of security, affirmation, and trust. Linguistically, *Imān* means to affirm something as true and to feel secure in it.

Technical Definition (Islamic Terminology):

In Islamic theology, Imān refers to the firm conviction and acceptance of the truth of what was revealed by Allah (God) through His Prophet Muhammad (PBUH). It is a comprehensive concept that encompasses belief in the heart, affirmation by the tongue, and actions by the limbs.

"Imān is to believe with the heart, confess with the tongue, and act with the limbs.")

Belief in Islam is not limited to intellectual assent but is manifested through practice, character, and commitment.

The Importance of Belief in Islam

Belief is the foundation of a Muslim's identity and the first requirement for entering Islam. Without belief, acts of worship or righteous deeds are not accepted by Allah. The Qur'an emphasizes belief as the first pillar of righteousness and the gateway to salvation.

"Indeed, those who have believed and done righteous deeds — they will have the Gardens of Paradise as a lodging."

— *Surah Al-Kahf* (8:07)

The Fundamental Beliefs in Islam (Articles of Faith)

The essential beliefs of Islam are known as the Six Articles of Faith (Arkan al-Imān). These are derived from the Qur'an and authentic hadith, especially the famous Hadith of Jibrīl (Gabriel)

Interrelation between Belief and Practice

In Islam, belief is **not merely theoretical**. It must be accompanied by righteous action. The Qur'an often couples "**belief and good deeds**" emphasizing the **dynamic relationship between faith and practice**.

Six Articles of Faith in Islam

Article	Arabic Term	Description
1)	Imān bi-Tawhid	Belief in the Oneness of Allah
2)	Imān bil-Malā'ikah	Belief in Angels

Article	Arabic Term	Description
3)	Imān bil-Kutub	Belief in the Books
4)	Imān bir-Rusul	Belief in the Prophets
5)	Imān bil-Yawm al-Ākhir	Belief in the Last Day
6)	Imān bil-Qadar	Belief in Divine Decree

Recommended Readings for Further Study:

1. **"The Fundamentals of Tawheed"** by Dr. Bilal Philips
2. **"Aqeedah al-Tahawiyyah"** (with commentary)
3. **"Islamic Belief System"** by Jamal al-Din Zarabozo
4. **Selected chapters from Sahih Muslim and Sahih Bukhari on Imān**

Iman bil-Tawhid (Belief in the Oneness of God)

“Tawhid means attributing Oneness to Allah the Almighty and describing Him as being One and Unique, with no partner or peer in His Essence and Attributes.”

Tawhid is the most sensitive and significant creed in the sight of Allah the Almighty. The foundation of Islam is based on this creed. Until and unless we don't have deep cognition of this creed our faith is at stake. We can never achieve the essence of Iman without comprehension of this belief. Without recognizing Him, we will never be able to develop a relationship with him.

We should strive to learn this fundamental concept of Monotheism. We should have our reasons and logic based on the Qur'an and Hadith to strengthen our belief in the existence of Allah the Almighty. We should develop a personal connection with Allah the exalted. When we will recognize Him in the true sense only then we will be able to follow Him in true letter and spirit. As mentioned in the Qur'an:

إِنَّمَا يَخْشَى اللَّهَ مِنْ عِبَادِهِ الْعُلَمَاءُ

Those who truly fear Allah, among His servants, who know Allah. (5:8)

Tawhid is the primary and core subject of the Qur'an. There is a Hadith that mentions that Surah Ikhlas is one-third of the Qur'an. Surah Ikhlas has been given this status because of the theme mentioned in it. It solely elucidates the concept of Tawhid.

. (O Esteemed Messenger!) Proclaim: 'He is Allah, Who is the One.

. Allah is the Transcendent of all, the Protector and Far-Superior to all.

. He has not begotten any, nor is He begotten.

. Nor is there anyone equal to Him.'

Allah the Almighty is the most Unique and Exalted as He is the creator. Nothing can be brought into His comparison. He is the most Supreme Being in the entire world. He alone is the Sustainer of all the Universes and the whole creation. Everything is dependent on Him but He is independent of everyone. His being is the practical manifestation of absolute Oneness.

Importance of Tawhid in the Qur'an

“And We did not send any Messenger before you, but We revealed to him (saying): none has the right to be worshipped but I (Allah), so worship Me (Alone).” Al-Anbiya:5]

And at another place in the Qur'an Allah the Almighty mentioned,

“And verily, We have sent among every Ummah (nation) a Messenger (proclaiming): “Worship Allah (Alone), and avoid (or keep away from) Taghut.” An-Nahl:6]

Repeatedly stating the subject of Tawhīd in diverse ways and styles and at different places in the Qur'an indicates the emphasis and significance of the belief of Tawhid. Allah the Almighty used the exact statement for other Prophets in the Qur'an regarding Tawhid.

“Say (O Muhammad): “But in truth, He (Allah) is the only one God. And truly I am innocent of what you join in worship with Him.” Al-Anaam:9]

So, till the last messenger, the message of the Oneness of Allah the Almighty was sent to mankind which shows its high importance.

Types of Tawhid

- . Rububiyah (Lordship)
- . Uluhiyyah (Worship)
- . Asmaa Was-Sifaat (Names and Attributes)

Rububiyah (Lordship)

- This category is based on the fundamental concept that Allah the Almighty alone caused all things to exist when there was nothing. This is known as creation Ex Nihilo (Latin for **creation out of nothing**) is the doctrine that matter is not eternal but had to be created by some divine creative act.
- He sustains and maintains creation without any need from it or for it and He is the sole Lord of the universe and its inhabitants without any real challenge to His sovereignty.
- In Arabic, the word used to describe this creator sustainer quality is Rububiyah which is derived from the root “Rabb” (Lord). This is proved by Allah the Almighty statement in Surah Al-Fatihah, verse one where He says, “[All] praise is due] to Allah, Lord of the worlds mankind, jinn, and all that exists]”.

- According to this category, since God is the only real power in existence, it is He who gave all things the power to move and to change. Everything is dependent on His become and He is the only independent Being.

All these facts have been explained in Sura al-Naml in a comprehensive way from 60-65 verse.

Well, Who has created the heavens and the earth and poured down water for you from the atmosphere in the sky? Then with that (water), We brought forth fresh and beautiful gardens. It was not possible for you to grow plants in these (gardens). Is there any (other) God besides Allah? In fact, they are the people who are turning away (from the path of truth). Or, Who made the earth a dwelling place and made rivers amid it and made for it huge mountains and put a barrier between the two seas (of salt and sweet waters)? Is there any (other) God besides Allah? But most of these (disbelievers) do not have knowledge. Or, Who grants the supplication of the anxiety-stricken caller when he calls upon Him, and Who removes the trouble and makes you successors and inheritors (of the predecessors) in the earth? Is there any (other) God besides Allah? You people accept advice but little. Or, Who guides you in the darkness of land and sea and sends winds as good news before (the rain of) His mercy? Is there any (other) God besides Allah? Exalted is Allah, High above (the false gods) which they associate with Him. Well, Who originates creation and shall repeat the same (process of creation), and Who grants you sustenance from the heavens and the earth? Is there any (other) God besides Allah? Say: ‘(O polytheists,) bring your proof if you are truthful. Say: ‘Those who are in the heavens and the earth do not have the knowledge of the unseen (by themselves) except Allah (Who is Self-Knowing), nor do they know when they will be raised up (alive again).’

Uluhiyyah (Worship)

This means having a firm conviction that only Allah is the true and only God worthy of worship. In Arabic, the term ibadah (worship) is associated with obedience, subservience, and submission. It has been defined by some scholars as “complete love accompanied by complete submission”. Thus, worship in all its forms cannot be dedicated to anyone else besides Allah the Almighty. It is important to point out that the concept of worship is all-embracing. Worship transcends the five pillars of Islam and covers all the good things and deeds that please Allah the Almighty. Therefore, things like supplication, reliance, obedience, subservience, and submission would be covered by this definition. All these things should be done solely for the sake of Allah the Almighty.

Evidence of this type of Tawhid is in Allah the Almighty statement “And I Allah did not create the jinn and men except that they should worship Me (alone)”. Surah Zariyat: 56]

➤ ‘Kalima’ as an example of Uluhiyyah

- ilah- one who is worshipped, on account of greatness and power is considered worthy to be worshipped.

- La ilaha illallah –There is no ilah other than one great being known by the name Allah the Almighty.
- It means that in the whole of the universe, there is absolutely no being worthy to be worshipped other than Allah the Almighty.
- That is only to Him our heads should bow in submission and adoration.

Our Prayers, charity, dua, tawaf, sajda, etc. are the acts of worship. If we perform them for anyone else other than Allah the Almighty then it is Shirk.

Asmaa Was-Sifaat (Names and Attributes)

This category of Tawhid has five main aspects:

- Unity of Allah the Almighty names and attributes to be maintained in the first aspect.
- Allah the Almighty must be referred to according to how He and His Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) have described Him instead of explaining His names and attributes by giving them meanings other than their obvious meanings.
- The second aspect of Tawhid al-Asmaa wasSifaat involves referring to Allah the Almighty as He has referred to Himself without giving Him any new names or attributes.
- In the third aspect of Tawhid al-Asmaa wasSifaat (اسماء و صفات) Allah the Almighty is referred to without giving Him the attributes of His creation. For example, it is claimed in the Bible and Torah that Allah the Almighty spent the first six days creating the universe and then slept on the seventh. For this reason, Jews and Christians take either Saturday or Sunday as a day of rest in which work is looked at as a sin.
- The fourth aspect of Tawhid al-Asmaa wasSifaat requires that man not be given the attributes of Allah the Almighty to His Almighty level. In reality, all the attributes belong to Allah the Almighty in true essence. He has distributed His attributes to the creation for a certain period e.g. a man can be Raheem but not to the level of Allah the Almighty. All the attributes of Allah are incomparable as they are not dependent on anyone but the attributes of the Creator are independent. The attributes of creation have a start and end time but His attributes are free from creation and eternal like Creator. The abilities of creation are limited and confined like them and all the abilities of the Creator are limitless and perpetual.

The Example of Hayy and Qayyum

Al-Hayy and al-Qayyum are His two unique attributes. He is the only one who is free from creation. He has not started or ended. He is free from the boundary of time as He is the creator of time. There was a time when there was no time but He existed in that time as well. He is the only one who is eternal, immortal, and perpetual.

- Maintaining the unity of Allah the Almighty names also means that Allah the Almighty names in the definite form cannot be given to His creation unless preceded by the prefix 'Abd meaning “slave of” or “servant of”.

Shirk (Associating partners) with Allah is an Unforgivable Sin

“And indeed, it has been revealed to you (O Muhammad), as it was to those before you: If you join others in worship with Allah the Almighty, (then) surely (all) your deeds will be in vain, and you will certainly be among the losers.” Az-Zumar:65]

This was said to Prophet Muhammad (PBUH), that even if you commit shirk with Allah the Almighty then all of your good deeds will be wasted.

“Verily, Allah the Almighty forgives not that partners should be set up with Him, but He forgives what is less than that to whomever He wills...” An-Nisa:8]

These references to verses from the Qur'an show that Shirk is an unforgivable sin. This shows that if someone has committed the sin of shirk and then seeks repentance for it then Allah the Almighty forgives him but if someone dies on the belief of shirk then surely, he will meet the fire in Hell.

Why Shirk is an unforgivable sin?

Shirk is to associate someone other than Allah the Almighty in those aspects that are unique to Allah the Almighty and His exclusive right. Shirk is to worship created beings like Allah the Almighty is worshipped, to venerate created beings like Allah the Almighty must be venerated, and to assign a portion of His divinity to someone else.

So, on the Day of Judgment Allah, the Almighty will ask that person who did shirk that as you have done this deed for another person or god other than Me then ask the reward of it from that false God.

In the Bible, it is mentioned that on the Day of Judgment, people will come to Prophet Jesus and ask him O Lord, O Lord, we did charity in Thy name and they will mention their good deeds in Prophet Jesus's name. While Prophet Jesus will say that getaway you evildoers, I even don't know you?

In the Qur'an, Allah the Almighty has mentioned that on the Day of Judgment when people come to Prophet Jesus, Allah the Almighty will ask Prophet Jesus, “O Isa, did you tell them to worship you besides Me? Or your mother besides Me?” and Prophet Jesus will say, Allah the Almighty you know what is in my heart, I have never told them to worship me”.

Allah the Almighty has mentioned categorically in the Qur'an that Isa and his mother don't have the authority to be your beneficiary. The people who are worshipping them will be in severe trouble on the Final Day.

Our intrinsic nature, Fitrah is inclined towards the Oneness of God and all the design of nature shows the glory and Oneness of a single Designer, hence that made the shirk an unforgivable sin as all the proofs of the Oneness of God are present in. So, one has to go against their nature to shirk.

Repentance before Death

There is a Sahih Hadith, an old man who came to Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) with a stick in his hand as a support for walking, He said to Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) what do you say about a person who has committed every sin, big or small, he has not left any of it? Ya Rasulullah! I am an old man I have done that all. Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) said have you said Shahdah? He said yes.

Then Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) said, from this moment, you do righteous deeds and don't go back to those sins, Allah the Almighty will forgive you and will turn your bad deeds into good deeds.

That person was shocked and said that even my treachery and the way I hurt other people would be forgiven. Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) said, yes even those, and then he lifted his stick and went back with slogans of Allahu Akbar Allahu Akbar.

The true repentance changes us and our ways of life. This is the significance of real repentance.

Types of Shirk

The texts of the Qur'an and Sunnah indicate that shirk and the ascribing of rivals to Allah the Almighty sometimes puts a person beyond the pale of Islam and sometimes does not. Hence the scholars divided shirk into two types which they call shirk akbar (major shirk) and shirk asghar (minor shirk).

I. Major Shirk

This means ascribing to someone other than Allah the Almighty something that belongs only to Allah the Almighty, such as Lordship (ruboobiyyah), divinity (uloohiyyah), and the divine names and attributes (al-asma' wa'l-sifaat).

Major Shirk may sometimes take the form of beliefs:

- Such as the belief that there is someone else who creates, gives life and death, reigns, or controls the affairs of the universe along with Allah the Almighty.
- Or the belief that there is someone else who must be obeyed absolutely besides Allah the Almighty, so they follow him in regard as permissible or forbidden whatever he wants, even if that goes against the religion of the Messengers.
- Or they may associate others with Allah the Almighty in love and veneration, by loving a created being as they love Allah the Almighty. This is the kind of shirk that Allah the Almighty does not forgive.
- Or the belief that some know the Unseen as well as Allah the Almighty. It is also shirk to believe that there is someone who bestows mercy in a manner that is befitting only for Allah the Almighty, so he shows mercy as Allah the Almighty does and forgives sins and overlooks the bad deeds of his worshippers.

Particularly in this era, we should have to be very careful regarding the false creeds associated with the shrines in our region. This is prohibited to ask anything in any sense from the shrines. This is against the teachings of the Qur'an and the Sunnah of the Holy Prophet PBUH. The scholars of every sect have refuted this misguidance strictly. Muslims are only bound to follow the direct text of the Qur'an and Hadith. There is no need to be involved in ambiguous and uncertain literature.

II. Minor Shirk

This includes everything that may lead to a major shirk, or which is described in the scripts as being shirk but does not reach the extent of being a major shirk.

This is usually of two types:

- Being emotionally attached to some means which have no basis and for which Allah the Almighty has not given permission, such as hanging up "hands", turquoise beads, amulets, etc. because they offer protection or that they ward off the evil eye. But Allah the Almighty has not made them the means of such protection, either according to Shariah or according to the laws of the universe.

- Venerating some people or things in a way that does not go so far as ascribing lordship to them, such as swearing by something other than Allah the Almighty, or saying, "Were it not for Allah and So and so," etc.

- As the Holy Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) has clearly stated:

"What I fear most about you is the Minor Shirk. The Companions of the Prophet asked him, "What is minor shirk, ya Rasullah?" He said, 'Ar-riya-Showing off' Allah will say on the Day of Judgment when He pays the people for their deeds: Go to those for whom you have done Riyadh in the world and see if you would find the reward with them." (Musnad Ahmad bin Hanbal:57)

It means that people are more afraid of society. They are afraid of people but not of Allah. All their deeds are man-centered not God-centered. Allah the Almighty has mentioned this trait of human beings in the following words.

يَخْشَوْنَ النَّاسَ كَخَشْيَةِ اللَّهِ أَوْ أَشَدَّ خَشْيَةً

they feared men as they fear Allah or with even] greater fear. (al-Nisa:77)

The Concept of Ownership

In regards to Tawhid Muslims should understand this dogma clearly that everything we have belongs to Allah the Almighty. We are just the caretakers or custodians of all the valuables for a certain period. Ownership in reality belongs to alone Allah the Almighty. That is why suicide has been declared forbidden because even though this life is not ours it belongs to Allah. We were created at the decided time and will die in the same manner decided by Allah the Almighty. Parents, children, money, every relation and entirety we have belongs to Allah alone.

The example mentioned below will help to understand the above-mentioned concept. The most esteemed people after the Holy Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) are his Companions. After the conquest of Mecca when Muslims were maximum in number, under the supervision of the Holy Prophet Muhammad they fought the battle of Hunain. They have suffered a lot in this battle just because of one mistake. They have associated the triumph of all previous battles with their effort. Allah the Almighty condemned this sentence in the following words:

“Indeed, Allah has given you believer’s victory on many battlefields, even at the Battle of Hunain when you took pride in your great numbers, but they proved of no advantage to you. The earth, despite its vastness, seemed to close in on you, and then you turned back in retreat.” (al-Tawba:5)

It is narrated in Bukhari and Muslim that only 80 Companions were left with the Holy Prophet out of thousands. Afterward, Muslims won this battle only because of the Holy Prophet. We have to be very careful regarding every claim we have concerning our associations. Allah the Almighty is the only owner of everything in both worlds.

May Allah help us to contemplate the creed of Monotheism in true essence? Ameen.

Imān bil-Malā'ikah (Belief in Angels)

Belief in the Angels (Mala'ika) is an essential part of the Islamic faith. Their existence, attributes, and responsibilities are frequently mentioned in both the Qur'an and Hadith. Denying their existence is considered Kufr (disbelief), as belief in angels is one of the six articles of faith in Islam.

“The Messenger has believed in what was revealed to him from his Lord, and so have the believers... They believe in Allah, His angels, His books, and His messengers...” (Surah Al-Baqarah 2:285)

Nature and Characteristics of Angels

Angels are created from light (nur), as stated in Hadith:

“The angels were created from light...” (Sahih Muslim, Hadith 2996)

They have intangible bodies, and can assume different forms by Allah's will. Angels are neither male nor female and are free from human needs such as eating, drinking, and reproduction. Their primary purpose is to worship and obey Allah without fail. They never disobey His commands and perform their duties with precision and dedication.

“They do not disobey Allah in what He commands them but do what they are commanded.” (Surah At-Tahrim 66:6)

They continuously glorify and worship Allah without exhaustion:

“They exalt Him night and day and do not slacken.” (Surah Al-Anbiya 21:20)

It is a grave misconception to consider angels as mere forces of nature without life or form. The Qur'an describes them as real beings with distinct roles.

The Vast Number and Roles of Angels

Angels exist in great numbers across the heavens and the earth, each entrusted with specific duties:

- Some carry the Throne of Allah (Surah Al-Haqqah 69:17)
- Some are gatekeepers of Paradise and Hell (Surah Az-Zumar 39:73-75, Surah Al-Muddathir 74:30-31)
- Some are responsible for taking souls at the time of death. (Surah As-Sajdah 32:11)

The Four Archangels

Among all the angels, four hold the highest status due to their responsibilities:

1. Jibrā'il (Gabriel)

The angel of revelation. He delivered Allah's messages to the Prophets.

“This is indeed the word of a noble messenger. Who is possessed of power and with the Owner of the Throne, secure in position, obeyed there in the heavens and trustworthy. (Surah At-Takwir 81:19–21)

2. Mikā'il (Michael)

Responsible for providing sustenance and controlling the forces of nature, such as rain and vegetation.

3. Isrāfil

Entrusted with blowing the Trumpet to signal the end of the world and the Day of Judgment.

4. 'Izrā'il (Izrael)

The Angel of Death, tasked with removing the souls of the deceased, assisted by subordinate angels.

Belief in angels is a fundamental requirement of Islamic faith. Denying their existence or distorting their nature is a serious deviation from Islamic doctrine. The Qur'an and Hadith provide detailed and consistent affirmations of their reality, purpose, and roles.

Imān bil-Kutub Belief in the Books

Belief in the divinely revealed scriptures is a fundamental article of faith in Islam. It is among the six pillars of Iman (faith), and rejecting any of these scriptures — in their original, unaltered forms — is considered disbelief. Allah sent these books to various prophets over the course of history as a means to guide humanity toward righteousness, justice, and monotheism.

"The Messenger has believed in what was revealed to him from his Lord, and [so have] the believers. All of them have believed in Allah, His angels, His books, and His messengers..." (Surah Al-Baqarah 2:285)

These books were sent to different communities based on their needs and conditions. While each book had its purpose, they all carried the central message of Tawhid (the oneness of Allah) and guided people toward ethical and spiritual living.

The Tawrah (Torah)

The Tawrah was revealed to Prophet Musa (PBUH) for the guidance of the Children of Israel. It contained commandments, legal rulings, and spiritual teachings intended to regulate both personal conduct and community affairs.

“Indeed, We sent down the Torah, in which was guidance and light. The prophets who submitted [to Allah] judged by it for the Jews...” (Surah Al-Ma'idah 5:44)

The Tawrah provided a comprehensive legal and moral code, and it emphasized justice, accountability, and social reform. However, over time, many parts of it were distorted or lost, and interpretations became influenced by human intervention.

The Zabur (Psalms)

The Zabur was revealed to Prophet Dawud (David, PBUH). Unlike the Tawrah, the Zabur focused less on law and more on praise, worship, and spiritual wisdom.

“And to David We gave the Zabur.” (Surah An-Nisa 4:163)

It contained psalms and songs of praise glorifying Allah and expressing deep spiritual devotion. The Zabur served as a source of personal inspiration, particularly in times of hardship or moral reflection. It is considered a sacred text filled with heartfelt prayers and moral teachings, though the original text has not survived in its unaltered form.

The Injeel (Gospel)

The Injeel was revealed to Prophet ‘Isa (Jesus, PBUH). It confirmed the teachings of the Tawrah while also bringing forth new spiritual insights centered on mercy, compassion, and love.

“And We sent, following in their footsteps, Jesus, the son of Mary, confirming that which came before him in the Torah; and We gave him the Gospel, in which was guidance and light...” (Surah Al-Ma’idah 5:46)

The original Injeel was a divine revelation from Allah, not the same as the four Gospels (Matthew, Mark, Luke, and John) written later by human authors. The true Injeel emphasized monotheism and the continuity of divine guidance, but it too was later altered and lost in its original form.

The Qur’an: Final and Eternal Revelation

The Qur’an, revealed to Prophet Muhammad (PBUH), is the final and complete revelation from Allah. It serves as a confirmation of the previous scriptures and a correction of distortions made to them.

“He has revealed to you the Book in truth, confirming what was before it. And He revealed the Torah and the Gospel before as guidance for mankind, and He revealed the Criterion (the Qur’an).” (Surah Aal-Imran 3:3)

The Qur’an is the only scripture that has remained unchanged since its revelation over 1,400 years ago. Allah Himself guarantees its protection:

“Indeed, it is We who sent down the Reminder (the Qur’an), and indeed, We will be its Guardian.” (Surah Al-Hijr 15:9)

It is not only a spiritual guide but also a comprehensive manual for life, covering personal ethics, family life, social justice, governance, and human rights. It is also filled with prophecies and scientific phenomena that continue to be validated, further confirming its divine source.

Theological Significance of Belief in All Books

Believing in all the divine books means acknowledging their divine origin and respecting their role in the history of revelation. It does not mean following the previous scriptures as they exist today but believing that:

- Allah revealed these books in their original forms.
- Each served a specific community at a particular time.
- All conveyed the same essential message of monotheism and submission to Allah.
- The Qur'an abrogates and supersedes previous revelations, serving as the final criterion.

Belief in the revealed books is a key component of a Muslim's faith. It fosters an understanding of the continuity of divine guidance and shows that Islam is not a new religion but the final phase in the long history of prophetic messages. While earlier scriptures were sent to specific peoples and were subject to change, the Qur'an remains timeless, universal, and fully preserved.

As the last and final revelation, the Qur'an consolidates the teachings of all previous books and provides a complete way of life for all of humanity. Through it, the guidance of Allah remains alive, accessible, and protected until the end of time.

Imān bir-Rusul (Belief in the Prophets)

The Role and Nature of Prophethood (Nubuwwah) in Islam is a core concept in Islamic belief. It refers to the divine system by which Allah guides humanity through chosen individuals—Prophets (Nabi) and Messengers (Rasul). These Prophets serve as a vital link between Allah and mankind. They are not ordinary people; they are selected by Allah to deliver His message, teach His laws, and guide people towards what is right and away from what is wrong.

The Mission and Function of Prophets

Prophets are specially chosen by Allah to lead people towards truth and righteousness. Their mission is to:

Teach people about Allah's oneness (Tawheed)

Deliver divine laws (Shariah)

Warn people against evil and disbelief

Give glad tidings of Paradise to the believers and warn of Hell for the disbelievers

“[We sent] messengers as bringers of good tidings and warners so that mankind will have no argument against Allah after the messengers.”

(Surah An-Nisa 4:165)

Difference between a Nabi and a Rasul

While all Rasuls (Messengers) are Nabis (Prophets), not all Nabis are Rasuls.

A Nabi is someone who receives revelation from Allah but may not be given a new law or scripture.

A Rasul is a Prophet who is given a new set of laws or a divine book to deliver to his people.

The Prophet Muhammad ﷺ said:

“The chain of Messengers and Prophets has come to an end. There will be no Prophet after me.”(Musnad Ahmad, Sahih)

Some narrations mention that there were around 124,000 Prophets, but only a smaller number among them were Messengers.

Infallibility (Ismah) of the Prophets

Prophets are protected by Allah from major and minor sins. This divine protection (Ismah) ensures that they serve as perfect role models for humanity. They still have free will, but Allah keeps them away from error in matters of religion and morality.

“Indeed, in the Messenger of Allah you have an excellent example for whoever has hope in Allah and the Last Day and remembers Allah often.” (Surah Al-Ahzab 33:21)

If a Prophet makes a mistake, it is not out of sin or rebellion, but due to a human misunderstanding or misjudgment, and Allah corrects them.

For example, the story of Prophet Adam eating from the tree is seen not as a sinful act, but as a moment of forgetfulness:

“And We had already taken a promise from Adam before, but he forgot; and We found not in him determination [to disobey].” (Surah Ta-Ha 20:115)

Miracles (Mu'jizat)

Prophets are given miracles by Allah as a proof of their truthfulness. These miracles break the laws of nature and cannot be performed by humans. They serve as signs (Ayat) to convince people of the divine origin of the Prophet’s message.

Examples include:

Prophet Ibrahim: The fire became cool and safe when he was thrown into it.

“We said, ‘O fire, be coolness and safety upon Abraham.’” (Surah Al-Anbiya 21:69)

Prophet Musa: The sea split for him and his people.

“Then We inspired to Moses, ‘Strike the sea with your staff,’ and it parted, and each portion was like a great towering mountain.” (Surah Ash-Shu‘ara 26:63)

Prophet Isa: He cured the blind and raised the dead, by Allah's permission.

“And I cure the blind and the leper, and I give life to the dead — by Allah's permission.” (Surah Aal-Imran 3:49)

Miracles performed by righteous people (awliya) after the time of Prophets are called karamat, but they are seen as extensions of the truthfulness of their Prophet. For example, Maryam (Mary), the mother of Isa (Jesus), received food miraculously:

“Whenever Zakariya entered upon her in the prayer chamber, he found with her provision.” (Surah Aal-Imran 3:37)

The Obligation of Belief in all Prophets

Belief in all Prophets and Messengers is a core requirement in Islam. Rejecting even one Prophet is considered disbelief, as all Prophets preached the same core message: belief in Allah and righteous living.

“Indeed, those who disbelieve in Allah and His messengers and wish to make a distinction between Allah and His messengers... they are in truth disbelievers.” (Surah An-Nisa 4:150–151)

The Qur'an often criticizes people who rejected some Prophets while believing in others, stating that such selective belief is unacceptable.

Finality of Prophethood (Khatm an-Nubuwwah)

The belief that Prophet Muhammad ﷺ is the final Prophet is central to Islamic theology. No Prophet or Messenger will come after him.

“Muhammad is not the father of any man among you, but he is the Messenger of Allah and the Seal of the Prophets.” (Surah Al-Ahzab 33:40)

The term “Seal of the Prophets” (Khatam al-Nabiyyin) has been unanimously understood to mean that Prophethood has ended with him. Any claim to Prophethood after him is considered false and a denial of this core belief.

Hadith Evidence for Finality

Numerous authentic hadith confirm this:

“There will arise thirty great liars in my Ummah, each of them claiming to be a Prophet. But I am the last of the Prophets, there is no Prophet after me.” (Sunan Abu Dawood, Sahih)

“The example of me and the Prophets before me is like a man who built a beautiful house... but one brick was missing. I am that last brick, and I am the last of the Prophets.” (Sahih al-Bukhari)

“You (Ali) are to me as Harun was to Musa, except that there is no Prophet after me.”
(Sahih Muslim)

Wisdom behind the Finality of Prophethood

Two major reasons explain why Prophethood ends with Muhammad ﷺ:

His Superior Rank: Prophet Muhammad ﷺ is the greatest and final Prophet. If another Prophet were to come, it would challenge the completeness of his message or imply a need for further guidance — which would contradict the perfection of Islam.

The Qur'an is Complete and Protected:

The Qur'an is a comprehensive guide for all of humanity, covering every aspect of life.

“And We have sent down to you the Book as clarification for all things and as guidance and mercy...”

(Surah An-Nahl 16:89)

Allah has also promised to protect the Qur'an from any corruption:

“Indeed, it is We who sent down the Reminder, and indeed, We will be its Guardian.”(Surah Al-Hijr 15:9)

Since the message is perfect and preserved, there is no need for another Prophet or new revelation.

Imān bil-Yawm al-Ākhir (Belief in the Last Day)

In Islam, the Day of Judgment (Yawm al-Qiyāmah) is the final and most important event in the life of every human being. It is the day when Allah will resurrect all of creation, judge them for their beliefs and deeds, and determine their eternal fate—either Paradise or Hell. Belief in the Day of Judgment is one of the six pillars of faith (Iman) and serves as a constant reminder of personal accountability and the temporary nature of worldly life. The Qur'an emphasizes its certainty:

"Indeed, the Hour is coming—there is no doubt about it—and Allah will resurrect those in the graves."

(Surah Al-Hajj 22:7)

This belief inspires Muslims to live righteous, meaningful lives, striving for good deeds, repentance, and justice, knowing that every action will be weighed and every soul will face its ultimate reward or punishment.

The Phase of Death and Barzakh

In Islam, death marks the beginning of the soul's journey to the afterlife. It is the moment when the soul separates from the body. After death, the soul is placed in a specific state or station and remains connected—at varying degrees—to the body or its remains in the

grave. This period is known as Barzakh, a realm between the physical world and the Day of Judgment.

During Barzakh, the soul can experience comfort or punishment, depending on its deeds in this world.

"And behind them is a barrier (Barzakh) until the Day they are resurrected."(Surah Al-Mu'minun 23:100)

The events of Barzakh are metaphysical—they cannot be detected by human senses. A helpful comparison is the experience of a dream, where one may see and feel things that others around them cannot observe.

The Prophet ﷺ said:

“When a believer is buried, two angels come and ask... If he answers correctly, his grave is expanded and filled with light. If not, the grave is tight and filled with fire.” (Musnad Ahmad)

The pain of the punishment is so severe that the dead scream, but only animals can hear them.

“He hears the beat of their sandals as they leave, and then he is questioned...” (Sahih al-Bukhari)

Phases of the Day of Judgment (Yawm al-Qiyamah)

The Day of Judgment is a promised reality. It begins with the blowing of the Trumpet by the angel Israfil, which will cause all life to cease.

“And the Trumpet will be blown, and all who are in the heavens and the earth will fall dead, except whom Allah wills.” (Surah Az-Zumar 39:68)

After forty years, Israfil will blow the Trumpet again, and all the dead will be resurrected.

The main purpose of this day is to:

Reward the righteous

Punish the wicked

The Great Intercession (Ash-Shafa‘ah al-‘Uzma)

After a long and unbearable wait, people will go to various Prophets seeking someone to intercede with Allah to start the reckoning. Each Prophet will decline until they reach Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, who will say:

"I am for it (the intercession)." (Sahih al-Bukhari)

He will intercede, and the Day of Judgment will begin.

Stages of the Reckoning (Hisab)

1. Distribution of Deeds

Every person will be given a Book of Deeds:

The righteous will receive it in their right hand.

The wicked will receive it in their left hand or from behind their back.

"Then as for he who is given his record in his right hand, he will be judged with an easy account... But as for he who is given his record behind his back, he will cry out for destruction." (Surah Al-Inshiqaq 84:7–12)

2. Weighing of Deeds (Mizan)

A scale will be set up to weigh good and bad deeds.

"And We shall set up the scales of justice for the Day of Resurrection, so that no soul is treated unjustly in anything."

(Surah Al-Anbiya 21:47)

Those whose good deeds are heavier will succeed.

3. Witnesses

Angels, who recorded the deeds, will testify.

The Prophets will testify against or for their nations.

Even a person's body parts will bear witness.

"That Day, their tongues, hands, and feet will testify against them about what they used to do." (Surah An-Nur 24:24)

Crossing the Sirat and Final Destinations

Before entering Paradise, believers will be given water from the Pond of Al-Kawthar, a gift to Prophet Muhammad ﷺ.

Then, they must cross the Bridge of Sirat, which is laid over Hell.

The righteous will cross quickly, like lightning.

The weak in faith will cross slowly.

Some will fall into Hell, dragged by hooks for their sins.

"There is none among you but will pass over it (Hell); this is with your Lord, a decree which must be accomplished." (Surah Maryam 19:71)

Some believers who wronged others will be stopped at a bridge between Paradise and Hell to settle their disputes before entering Paradise.

Paradise (Jannah) and Hell (Jahannam)

Both Paradise and Hell are real, eternal places.

The journey of the soul, from death to resurrection, and ultimately to either Paradise or Hell, is central to Islamic belief. The stages—Barzakh, Qiyamah, Reckoning, and the final destination—remind us of our responsibility in this life. Through sincere faith and righteous action, one can hope for Allah's mercy and eternal success in the Hereafter.

Imān bil-Qadar (Belief in Divine Decree)

Belief in Qadr (divine destiny) and Qadha (divine execution or decree) is one of the six pillars of faith in Islam. It means that everything in the universe—whether good or bad—happens according to Allah's perfect knowledge and will.

Qadr – Divine Destiny

Qadr refers to Allah's eternal knowledge and plan for all creation. Before the universe was created, Allah already knew and recorded everything that would happen, including all events and actions.

"Indeed, We have created all things with Qadr (predestination)." (Surah Al-Qamar 54:49)

"Allah has set a measure for everything." (Surah At-Talaq 65:3)

This shows that nothing happens by accident—everything is within Allah's divine wisdom and decree.

Qadha – Divine Execution

Qadha is the actual creation and execution of Allah's plan. It means Allah brings about everything in the world according to what He had already destined.

Although our actions are in the knowledge of Allah, still it doesn't impact on our free will. We choose our actions, but Allah already knows what we will choose and has created the results based on His ultimate knowledge.

The Prophet ﷺ said:

"Everyone will find easy that for which he was created." (Sahih al-Bukhari)

This Hadith shows that while Allah knows our future, we still choose our path freely.

Dua (Supplication) and Destiny

Some may wonder: If everything is already written, what is the use of making dua (prayer)?

Islam teaches that dua is powerful and can change one's conditional destiny. While some aspects of destiny are fixed and cannot change (definite destiny), others are conditional and can change based on a person's actions, especially sincere prayer and repentance.

The Prophet ﷺ said:

“Nothing repels destiny except dua, and nothing increases lifespan except righteousness.”

(Sunan At-Tirmidhi, Hasan)

So, making dua is not against belief in destiny—it is part of Allah's plan. He has already decreed that some outcomes will occur only if we ask.